IAN PITMAN

ipitman@uchicago.edu – https://ipitman.github.io/ – (510) 708-7246

Placement Director:	Manasi Deshpande	mdeshpande@uchicago.edu	(773) 702-8260
Graduate Administrator:	Kathryn Falzareno	kfalzareno@uchicago.edu	(773) 702-3026

Office Contact Information

University of Chicago, Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
Saieh Hall for Economics
5757 S University Ave
Chicago, IL 60637

Education

University of Chicago, Ph.D. in Economics *2021–present*

University of Chicago, B.A. in Economics (Honors) and Mathematics *2015–2019*

References

Professor Azeem Shaikh (Chair)
University of Chicago
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
amshaikh@uchicago.edu
(773) 834-9405

Professor Alexander Torgovitsky
University of Chicago
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
atorgovitsky@gmail.com
(773) 795-2930

Professor Kirill Ponomarev
University of Chicago
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
kponomarev@uchicago.edu
(773) 834-5960

Research and Teaching Fields

Econometrics

Job Market Paper

Optimal Confidence Procedures for Partially Identified Parameters

Abstract: *This paper constructs optimal confidence procedures in a flexible class of partially identified models. First, I develop a decision-theoretic framework in which reporting a confidence set incurs a loss equal to its excess length: the length of the part that does not overlap with the identified set. Under my proposed framework, a confidence procedure is optimal if it minimizes worst-case expected excess length. Next, I show that the problem of constructing such a procedure reduces to solving a single optimal testing problem and inverting the resulting test. This theoretical insight allows me to leverage recent computational advances in optimal testing to numerically approximate the optimal procedure. In a series of calibrated simulations, I quantify the suboptimality of existing inference methods across a variety of empirical settings. I find that methods with the worst performance often direct power towards alternatives that are inconsistent with the model, which is never optimal. Finally, I illustrate the usefulness of my approach in an event study design from Iovino et al. (2026).*

Working Papers

Distribution-Free Inference on Willingness-to-Pay in Binary Choice Experiments
(with Alexander Torgovitsky)

Abstract: *Discrete choice experiments are widely-used in a large number of fields, including a growing subfield of labor economics that measures the valuation of non-pecuniary workplace amenities. In contrast to many other types of randomized experiments, the evaluation of a discrete choice experiment typically relies on parametric assumptions about the distribution of willingness-to-pay (WTP) for the choices. Logit or probit models are common. We provide nonparametric methods for evaluating discrete choice experiments in which subjects choose from two options. The methods produce analytic bounds on features of the distribution of WTP such as the mean, standard deviation, or quantiles. We develop inferential methods for these partially identified parameters that are based on isotonic regression. We use our methods to re-evaluate Mas and Pallais's (2017) influential study of the valuation for workplace amenities. Our findings show that most of their conclusions remain even without a parametric assumption on the distribution of WTP. One exception are their results on overtime, which we find are driven by the logistic functional form in their model.*

Quantifying Deterrence Effects in Judge Designs

Abstract: *To what extent can judges deter pretrial misconduct without detention? This question is becoming increasingly salient as jurisdictions across the United States enact bail reforms that make most people ineligible for monetary bail and pretrial detention. In this paper, I develop new econometric methods to learn about the deterrence effects of New York City's supervised release program, a de facto substitute for monetary bail following bail reform in New York State. I focus on identification and inference for a simple causal parameter: on average, how much does supervised release increase the court appearance rate of individuals with a given set of characteristics? I propose a parsimonious model of judge behavior that places intuitive restrictions on this parameter while allowing judges to have arbitrary private information. I demonstrate that under certain conditions, these restrictions still hold even if judges make decisions based on omitted payoffs or inaccurate beliefs. Finally, I present preliminary empirical results indicating that, on average, pretrial supervision increases court appearance rates by at least 2.9% but no more than 9.9% among the individuals in my sample.*

Work in Progress

Inference in Judge Designs with Multiple Margins of Treatment (with Yuehao Bai, Azeem Shaikh, and Ed Vytlacil)

Awards, Scholarships, and Grants

Becker Friedman Institute Public Economics Initiative Grant ($5,000)	*2024*
Lee Prize for Highest Score Earned on the Empirical Analysis Core Exam	*2022*
David S. Hu Award for Undergraduate Thesis in Economics	*2019*

Teaching Experience

Econometrics II - Honors (undergraduate)	TA for Prof. Torgovitsky	*Spring 2024*
Empirical Analysis I (graduate)	TA for Prof. Shaikh	*Fall 2023*
Topics in Modern Econometrics (graduate)	TA for Prof. Shaikh	*Spring 2023*
Machine Learning for Economists (graduate)	TA for Prof. Ponomarev	*Winter 2023*

Research Experience and Other Employment

Summer Intern, Microsoft Research New England *2025*

Pre-Doctoral Fellow for Prof. Greenstone, University of Chicago *2019–2021*

Professional Experience

Machine Learning in Economics Summer Institute Participant, University of Chicago *2022*

Presentations *Econometrics Working Group, University of Chicago*

Refereeing Activity *Journal of Political Economy*

Additional Information

Citizenship USA

Programming Skills Python, R

This version: October 23, 2026